

Elevance Payer Policy: Laparoscopic Gastric Bypass (Bariatric Surgery)

CPT/HCPCS Code: 43644 | Version: 2026-Q3 | Effective Date: 2026-07-01

Specialty Requirement

This service requires a referral from: Bariatric Surgery referral.

Required Supporting Documentation

1. Primary Care Clinical Notes
2. Psychological Evaluation Report
3. Registered Dietitian Counseling Logs

Clinical Prerequisites

1. BMI greater than 40, or BMI greater than 35 with at least one severe obesity-related comorbidity (e.g., Type 2 Diabetes, Severe Sleep Apnea)
2. Documented participation in a medically supervised weight loss program for at least 6 consecutive months
3. Clearance from a licensed psychologist or psychiatrist evaluating readiness for surgery

Notes

Requests lacking any of the required supporting documentation above will be returned to the provider for additional evidence unless the case includes clearly documented exigent circumstances warranting expedited review.